sun made its way down the valley. Reinhardt spoke of vengeance. For weeks now, she'd felt something in the air, a faint trembling of the ground and now she knew what it was—the rage of the Soviet army marching closer.

"I have very good information, from a source I trust, that any Russian civilian—male or female—found on German territory will be considered a traitor to the motherland and sent to the Gulag." He frowned. "Those women won't survive the Gulag."

"It's not their fault that they were dragged from their homes and brought to Germany."

"You speak of logic and rationality." He took a beat. "The Soviet command believes in brute force. They will have expected that those women should have fought to the death. Now, they'll see them as traitors." Strain showed around his eyes and jaw. "I sent them out of Germany to Prague. If they're found on Czech soil, it's better." He sighed.

"If it's not safe for them, what about me?" she asked.

"I will protect you. I'm making many arrangements to secure your safety. You can trust me." His eyes narrowed on her. "Have you spoken to André?"

"Of course not."

"Perhaps you should."

"You mean, tell him I'm marrying you?" She almost laughed.

"Do you want him looking for you, wondering, doubting whether you're still out there needing him to come rescue you? Or do you want to let him go so he can be free to love someone else?"

She had never considered how André would endure after this, or what he would do. The thought that he might come searching, refusing to abandon her, filled her with a fierce, aching love—and with dread. Reinhardt's gaze burned her. "André will move on," she said, holding her hands tight at her sides.

"Only if you let him go."

"How?"

"Tell him it's over."

"I don't think that's necessary." She didn't want to hurt him.

Reinhardt leaned forward, resting his elbows on the table. "You don't understand men," he said quietly. "After the war, André will poke around,